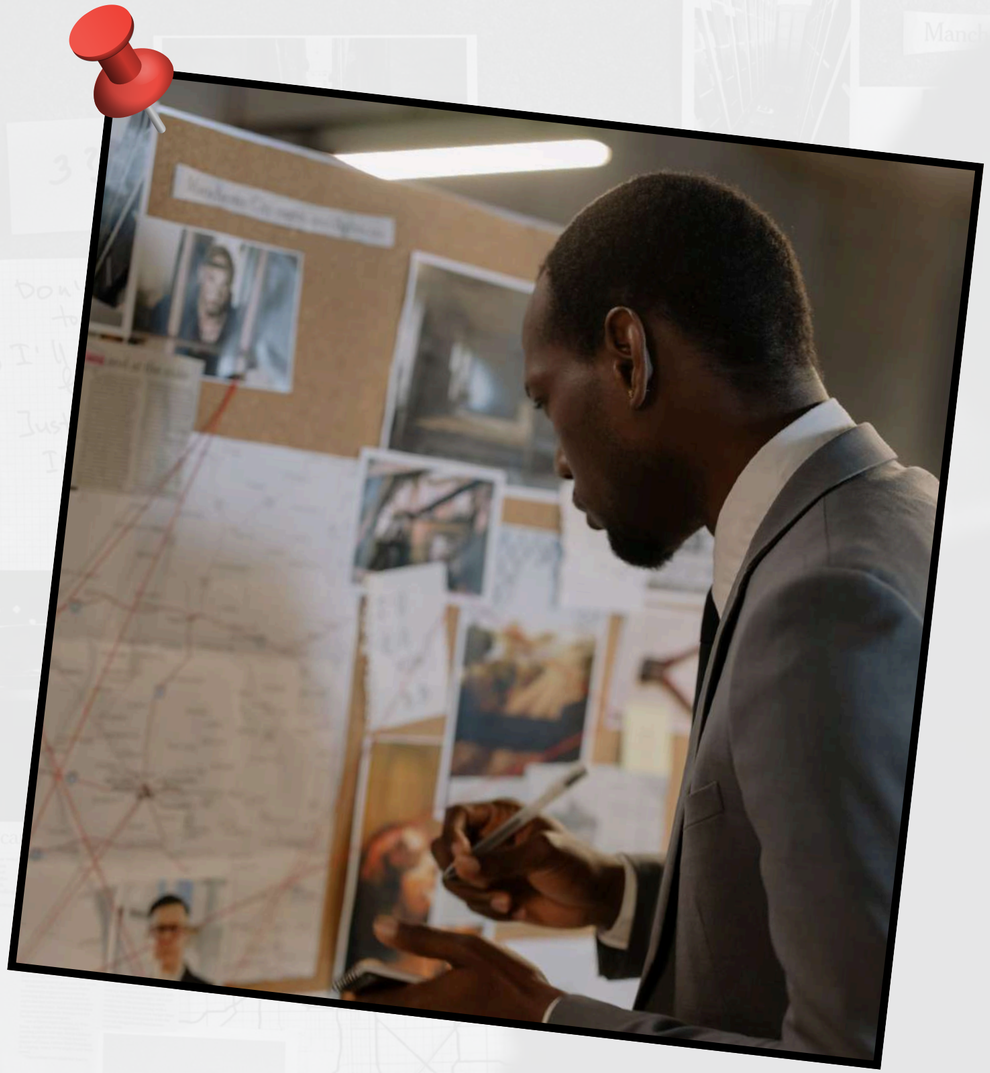

# CASE STUDY: RANSOMWARE CYBERCRIME

Ransomware is a type of cybercrime where attackers block access to a computer system or encrypt files, then demand payment (usually in cryptocurrency) to restore access. It is one of the fastest-growing cyber threats affecting individuals, businesses, and even governments.

# DISCUSS

A typical ransomware attack follows several steps. First, the attacker gains entry into a system through phishing emails, malicious downloads, or software vulnerabilities. For example, a user may unknowingly click on an infected email attachment. Second, the ransomware installs itself and begins encrypting important files on the device or network. Third, a ransom note appears on the screen, informing the victim that their data is locked and providing instructions to pay a fee within a limited time. Finally, even if the ransom is paid, there is no guarantee that access will be restored.

# COMMON TARGETS

Common targets include small businesses, hospitals, educational institutions, and individuals with weak cybersecurity practices. Attackers often choose victims who are more likely to pay quickly to regain access to critical data.

# CONSEQUENCE

The consequences of ransomware attacks can be severe. Victims may lose sensitive data, face financial losses, experience downtime, and suffer reputational damage. In critical sectors like healthcare, such attacks can even disrupt essential services, putting lives at risk.

**THIS CASE HIGHLIGHTS THE IMPORTANCE OF CYBERSECURITY AWARENESS, REGULAR DATA BACKUPS, AND CAUTIOUS ONLINE BEHAVIOR TO PREVENT SUCH INCIDENTS.**